

Ana Brassard

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Current position: Technical Staff I, Riken AIP Natural Language Understanding Team

Conducting independent and collaborative NLP research @ the Tohoku NLP Lab in Sendai, Miyagi, Japan
(Dec. 2018 - now)

Research interests:

Natural language processing; **commonsense reasoning** & knowledge; LLM testing, probing, and diagnostics; dataset creation; neuro-symbolic reasoning; robustness and interpretability.

Programming Experience

 GitHub: [/a-brassard](https://github.com/a-brassard)

Mainly **Python**, **PyTorch**-based deep learning, AMT crowdsourcing, API-based LLMs.

Language proficiency

English (fluent), **Japanese** (fluent), **French** (intermediate), **Croatian** (native).

Formal Education

Ph.D. (in progress)

2021 - *2025, Graduate School of Information Sciences, Tohoku University

Master of Science in Computing

2016 - 2018, Faculty of Electrical Engineering and Computing, University of Zagreb

Bachelor of Science in Computing

2013 - 2016, Faculty of Electrical Engineering and Computing, University of Zagreb

Selected Publications

- * ACORN: Aspect-wise Commonsense Reasoning Explanation Evaluation. [Brassard, A.](#); Heinzerling, B.; Kudo, K.; Sakaguchi K.; and Inui, K. (COLM 2024)
- * Empirical Investigation of Neural Symbolic Reasoning Strategies. Aoki, Y.; Kudo, K.; Kuribayashi T.; [Brassard, A.](#); Yoshikawa, M.; Sakaguchi, K.; Inui, K. (EACL 2023 Findings)
- * Do Deep Neural Networks Capture Compositionality in Arithmetic Reasoning? Kudo, K.; Aoki, Y.; Kuribayashi T.; [Brassard, A.](#); Yoshikawa, M.; Sakaguchi, K.; and Inui, K. (EACL 2023)
- * COPA-SSE: Semi-structured Explanations for Commonsense Reasoning. [Brassard, A.](#); Heinzerling, B.; Kavumba, P.; and Inui, K. (LREC 2022)
- * Context Limitations Make Neural Language Models More Human-Like. Kuribayashi, T.; Oseki Y.; [Brassard, A.](#); and Inui K. (EMNLP 2022)
- * Learning to Learn to be Right for the Right Reasons. Kavumba, P.; Henzerling, B.; [Brassard, A.](#); and Inui, K. (NAACL 2021)
- * Diamonds in the Rough: Generating Fluent Sentences from Early-Stage Drafts for Academic Writing Assistance. Ito, T.; Kuribayashi, T.; Kobayashi, H.; [Brassard, A.](#); Hagiwara, M.; Suzuki, J.; and Inui K. (INLG 2019)